Michael Kokaly

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Chicago **Aug 2024 - May 2028**
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Honors College

- GPA: 3.83/4.0
- Relevant Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Software Design, Systems Programming, Computer Architecture, Object-Oriented Design

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Intern **Remote**
Mylon Education *May 2026 - Present*

- Built an AI assistant (Python, FastAPI, LlamaIndex) that answers staff questions about university HR policies and cites the exact source document and page
- Built the retrieval pipeline end to end: PDF, DOCX, and HTML ingestion, chunking, embeddings, and semantic search with pgvector in PostgreSQL
- Secured data for multiple schools with JWT authentication and Postgres Row-Level Security, so each institution can only access its own records
- Wrote the technical spec and 6 architecture decision records that the team adopted as its build plan

Energy Systems Intern **Bridgeview, IL**
SYSERCO *June 2026 – Aug. 2026*

- Rotated through 8 departments, from engineering and panel building to sales and estimating, following projects from bid to final install
- Shadowed engineers through control panel design, fabrication, and field startup of building control systems
- Joined sales, estimating, and inventory work to see how cost, scope, and engineering limits shape project bids

Guest Services Manager **Elmhurst, IL**
Elmhurst Park District *May 2021 – Nov. 2026*

- Led and trained a team of 10–15 employees at a facility serving 400+ visitors per day
- Cut guest wait times by 25% by restructuring staff rotations and concession workflows

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Chicago Sky Tracker *(Java, Spring Boot, PostgreSQL, React, Azure)* *Oct. 2026 - Present*

- Built a live flight tracker that pulls aircraft data from the OpenSky API every 30 seconds using OAuth 2.0 and stores 260K+ positions per day in PostgreSQL
- Built Spring Boot REST APIs for live flights, flight paths, and "what flew over my house" search, using a geospatial (GiST) index to keep searches fast
- Cut long-term storage ~4× with a nightly cleanup job; deployed on Azure with a GitHub Actions pipeline that tests and deploys every push

Digital Footprint *(React, TypeScript, Three.js, Supabase, Vercel)* *Oct. 2026 - Present*

- Built and deployed a 3D globe app where users pin travel memories, photos, and videos to real locations
- Designed the PostgreSQL schema with row-level security so each user can only access their own memories and uploads

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Languages: Java, Python, TypeScript, SQL, C, C++, HTML/CSS
Frameworks & Tools: Spring Boot, React, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Supabase, pgvector, LlamaIndex, Git, GitHub Actions, Azure, Vercel
Spoken Languages: English (Native), Arabic (Fluent), Spanish (Basic)
Interests: Ping Pong, Dabke Dance Team, Dance Coach, Piano, Weightlifting, Calisthenics, Chess